

a better job advising others than investing for himself. That's when he started publishing his newsletter.

He ordered a cup of herbal tea and a sweet roll and explained his stock market theory as follows:

The general public is affected by sunspots that send out ionizing radiation, as well as by the phases of the moon. Electrically charged investors turn positive or negative in sympathy with the positive or negative atmospheric polarity, with the moon pulling the air, and also with the planetary alignments.

By keeping track of the planets and the electromagnetic emanations, Mr. Crawford said he'd called every major low point in the stock market since 1977, and within 15 points of the Dow Jones industrial average. Calling the highs had been more difficult, but he had the market going up in 1982-83 and topping out in 1984, all of which came true. If I wanted proof, he said he'd bring me the newspaper clippings from his office right around the corner. If that wasn't enough, he told me to call Wall Street columnist Dan Dorfman, who'd once investigated these results and came away impressed.

Looking into the future, Mr. Crawford took the grim view that "with Saturn and Neptune conjunct with Capricorn and opposing Cancer we could be facing very possibly the dissolution of the banking system." Fortunately, this wasn't going to happen until November 13, 1989. More immediate prospects included a "topping out of the stock market in April-May, and from there definitely a correction and quite possibly a bear market."

Mr. Crawford inspired great confidence, even after he let me pay for his sweet rolls and refused to invite me into his messy office, and in spite of the fact that I didn't believe in electrical beings. Maybe it was his gentle offhandedness. Maybe it was because he wasn't selling anything. (Actually, he did sell advice to sophisticated investors who, he said, paid thousands a year to hear it, but he wouldn't give me their names. Then there was the newsletter, but he volunteered to put me on the free list for that.)

Whatever the reason, I was anxious to hear what Mr. Crawford would do if he were in my position. "Buy calls on the market on Friday afternoon," he said, without any hesitation or uncertainty.